

Delhi Drowns in Smog as AQI Skyrockets to 460 – Citizens Struggle for Breath!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

A thick toxic haze blanketed Delhi today morning, reducing visibility and disrupting flights and train schedules as the capital battled hazardous air quality.

Detailed analysis:

The severe AQI surge highlights the urgent need for policy measures on air quality management. Candidates should note the health impacts, the government's emergency response (online classes, traffic restrictions), and the political pressure on the environment ministry.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/toxic-winter-delhis-aqi-breaches-460-ncr-cities-gasp-for-air-9816704#publisher=newsstand>

Delhi Schools Shut Down! Kids From Nursery to Class-5 Forced to Study Online as Pollution Turns Deadly

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Students from nursery to Class 5 will have to study in virtual mode compulsorily due to rising air pollution, the Delhi government said today.

Detailed analysis:

This decision reflects emergency education protocols under environmental crises. Aspirants should understand its impact on learning outcomes, digital divide issues, and how it fits into broader disaster-management frameworks.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/only-online-classes-for-nursery-to-class-5-in-delhi-schools-amid-severe-air-pollution-9816501#publisher=newsstand>

Historic Overhaul! Govt Plans to Erase MGNREGA, Replace It with 'G Ram G' – Sparks Nationwide Political Firestorm

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Setting the stage for a political face-off during the ongoing Winter Session of Parliament, the Centre has introduced a Bill that will replace the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee scheme (MGNREGA).

Detailed analysis:

The proposal touches on flagship welfare policies, federal-state dynamics, and electoral politics. Candidates should note the scheme's significance, the opposition's stance, and potential constitutional challenges.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/g-ram-g-to-replace-mnrega-new-bill-to-be-introduced-in-parliament-9811165#publisher=newsstand>

Supreme Court Demands Full Audio Evidence in Manipur Violence Case – Government Under Heat!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Supreme Court on Monday questioned why the entire available leaked audio clips, which a petition alleged pointed to the role of former Manipur chief minister N Biren Singh in the 2023 ethnic violence, were not sent for forensic examination.

Detailed analysis:

This highlights judicial oversight in conflict-related investigations. Aspirants should focus on the role of evidentiary standards, federal oversight, and implications for political accountability in insurgency-prone regions.

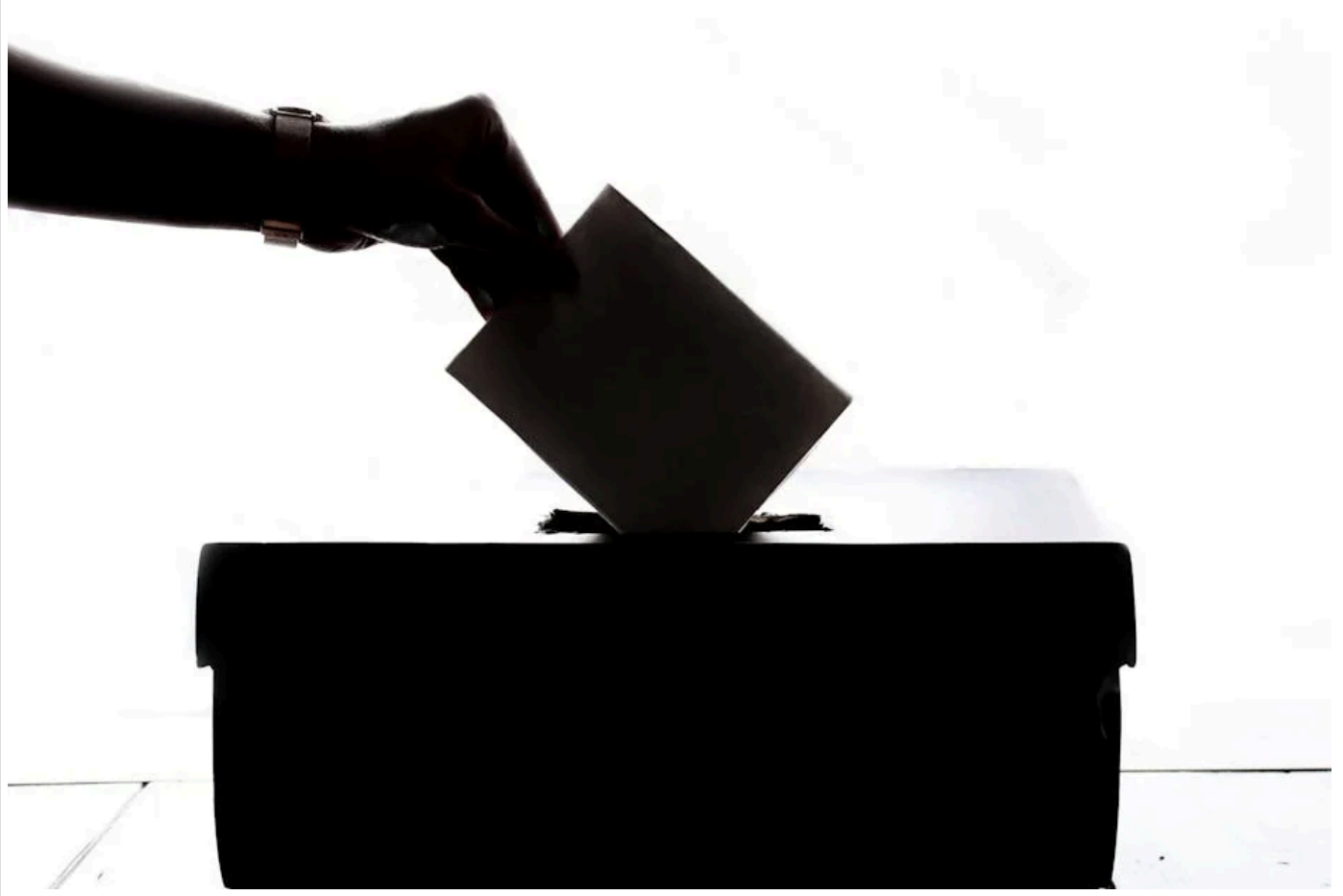
Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/manipur-violence-sc-asks-why-entire-leaked-clips-not-sent-for-forensic-test-9812825#publisher=newsstand>

BJP's New Powerhouse! Nitin Nabin Promises a 'Party Revamp' as National Working President

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Newly-appointed BJP national working president Nitin Nabin, after taking charge on Monday (December 15), vowed to strengthen the party and further consolidate its organisational structure with full strength, capability, and diligence.

Detailed analysis:

The appointment signals a strategic shift ahead of upcoming elections. Candidates should assess Nabin's political background, his potential role in party mobilisation, and the broader impact on the BJP's election strategy.

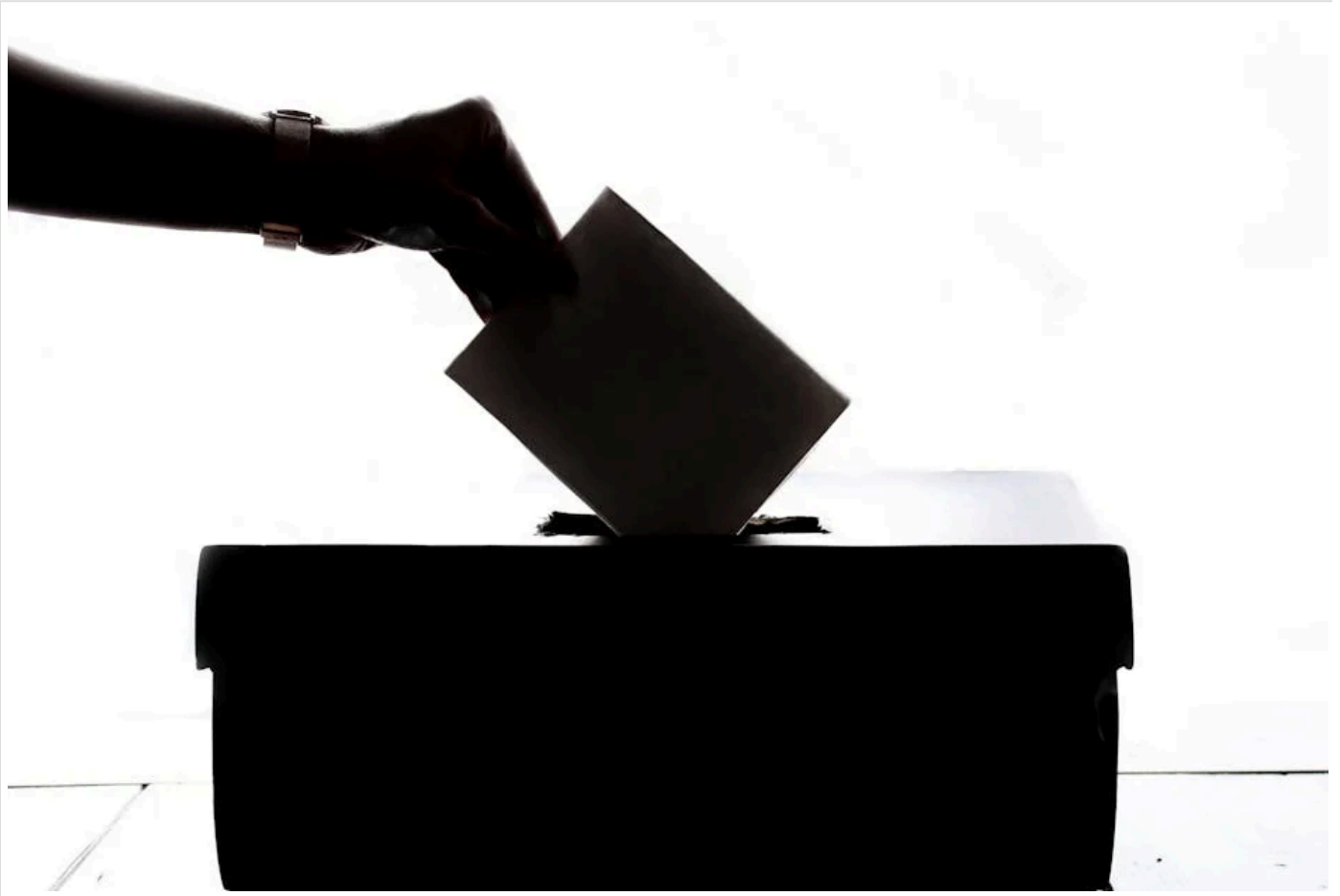
Source: <https://www.indiatvnews.com/news/india/nitin-nabin-vows-to-strengthen-bjp-after-taking-charge-as-bjp-national-working-president-latest-updates-2025-12-15-1021830>

Mumbai's Long-Awaited Municipal Elections Set for Jan 15 – A Political Earthquake in the Making!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Elections for Maharashtra's civic bodies, pending since 2022, will finally be held on January 15. Elections will be held for 29 municipal corporations, 32 district councils, and 336 panchayat samitis. The votes will be counted the next day.

Detailed analysis:

These civic polls are a litmus test for state-level parties ahead of the national elections. Aspirants should note the stakes for BJP, Shiv Sena, Congress, and the role of local governance in policy implementation.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/maharashtra-civic-polls-polls-for-mumbai-civic-body-bmc-to-be-held-on-january-15-results-on-january-16-9812713#publisher=newsstand>

— WORLD —

Europe's Fate Hangs on Ukraine Peace Talks – Inside the High-Stakes Summit!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The talks come at the start of a pivotal week for Europe, with an European Union summit set to decide whether it can underwrite a massive loan to Ukraine with frozen Russian Central Bank assets

Detailed analysis:

The negotiations are a litmus test for EU cohesion and its willingness to use frozen Russian assets to fund Ukraine. Success could unlock billions for Kyiv and reshape EU-Russia financial dynamics—key for exam questions on international finance and security.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/ukraine-peace-talks-stretch-into-second-day-at-start-of-pivotal-week-for-europe/article70398627.ece>

US Cracks Down on H-1B Dreamers: Social Media Checks Begin!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The United States will begin expanded social media and online presence vetting for H-1B visa applicants and their H-4 dependents starting December 15, according to the U.S. Embassy

Detailed analysis:

This policy adds a new layer of scrutiny for skilled migrants, directly affecting Indian IT professionals. Aspirants must note its impact on visa processing timelines and potential geopolitical friction over talent migration.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/watch-us-to-start-social-media-vetting-for-h-1b-and-h4-visa-seekers/article70399658.ece>

Terrorists Turn Tech-Savvy: AI Weaponised for Recruitment!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

As militant groups increasingly experiment with artificial intelligence, national security experts warn of the rising risks associated with this technology

Detailed analysis:

AI-driven propaganda amplifies recruitment and operational planning for extremist outfits. Understanding this trend is vital for security studies, counter-terrorism policy, and cyber-defence curricula.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/islamic-state-use-ai-for-recruiting-and-propaganda/article70398386.ece>

South Korea Scandal: Ex-President Yoon's Secret Plot for Martial Law Exposed!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Yoon Suk Yeol has steadfastly maintained that his martial law declaration was a desperate attempt to draw public support for his fight against the main liberal opposition Democratic Party, which obstructed his agenda

Detailed analysis:

The revelation highlights fragility in South Korean democratic institutions and the lengths political leaders may go to retain power—an important case study for comparative politics and governance.

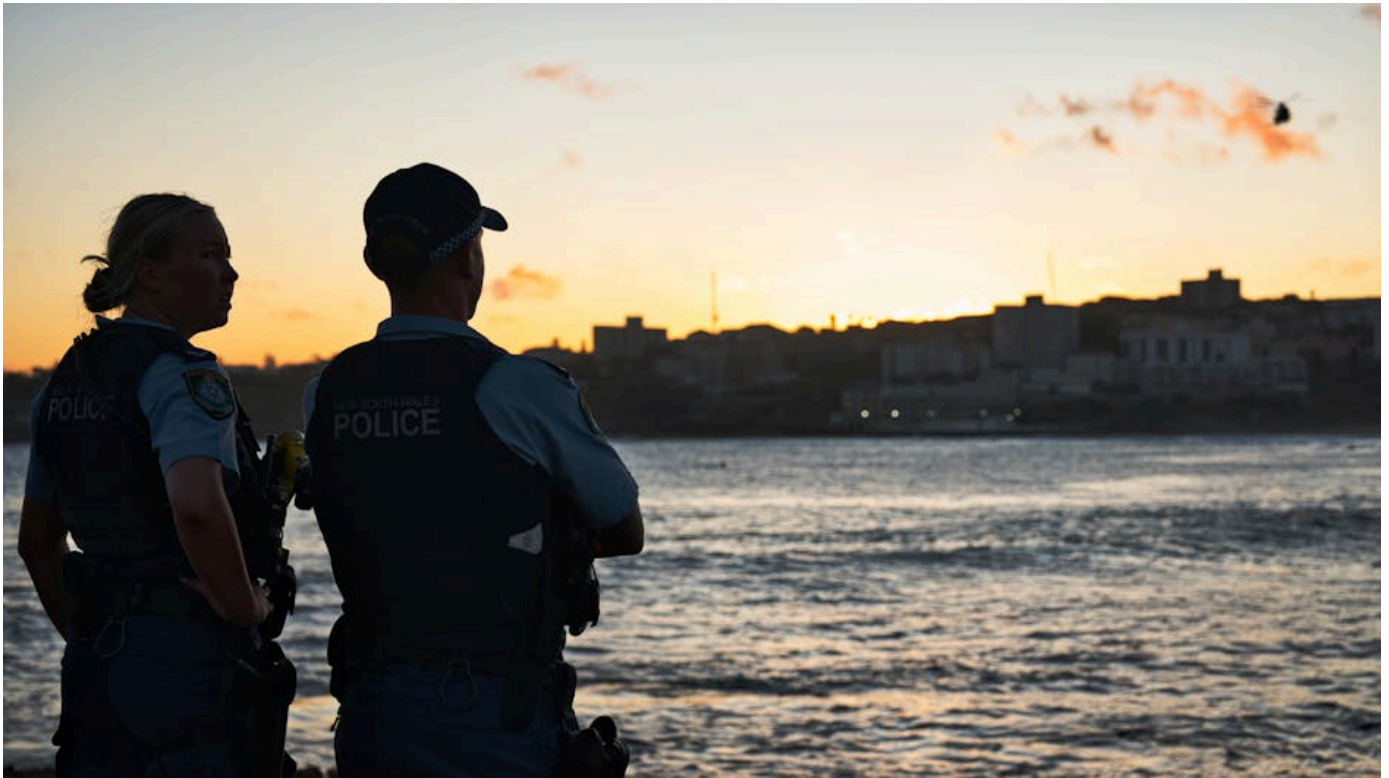
Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/south-koreas-ousted-president-yoon-plotted-martial-law-to-eliminate-rivals-probe-finds/article70398368.ece>

Australia Reels from 16-Dead Beach Massacre – New Gun Laws on the Horizon!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Albanese said he would propose new restrictions, including limiting the number of guns a licenced owner can obtain

Detailed analysis:

The incident reignites the global debate on firearm regulation. Australia's policy response offers a comparative model for India's own discussions on gun control and public safety.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/bondi-beach-shooting-australian-pm-proposes-tougher-national-gun-laws-after-mass-shooting-in-sydney/article70397819.ece>

India's Top Diplomat Heads to Israel – Strategic Talks Set to Redefine Indo-Israeli Ties!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

His visit comes days after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu spoke to his Indian counterpart Narendra Modi and the two leaders "agreed to meet very soon".

Detailed analysis:

The trip underscores India's balancing act in the Middle East, enhancing defence and tech cooperation while navigating Arab ties. Essential for understanding India's foreign policy calculus.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/jaishankar-to-visit-israel-on-december-16-2025-bilateral-talks/article70398820.ece>

Odisha MLAs Set to Pocket Triple Their Pay – From a Modest Lakh to a Fat ₹3.45 Lakh!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Odisha Legislative Assembly is considering a bill that would increase the monthly salary of its members three-fold, raising it from roughly ₹1.11 lakh to ₹3.45 lakh, subject to the Governor's approval.

Detailed analysis:

For civil-service and UPSC aspirants, this story illustrates how state-level fiscal decisions can affect public expenditure and political economics. It highlights the legislative process (bill → Governor's assent) and raises questions about salary structures, fiscal prudence, and public perception—key topics in the Governance and Economy sections of the exams.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/india/from-rs-1-11-lakh-to-rs-3-45-lakh-odisha-mlas-salary-may-triple-all-eyes-on-governor-s-assent-11765800984052.html>

Smog-Stranded? Grab Up to ₹10,000 Back from Airlines – Your Money-Back Survival Guide!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The article outlines passenger rights under Indian aviation law, detailing when travelers can claim full refunds or compensation of up to ₹10,000 for flight delays, cancellations, or disruptions caused by severe smog.

Detailed analysis:

Understanding consumer protection laws and aviation regulations is vital for general studies and banking exams. This piece teaches candidates about the Civil Aviation Requirements (CAR) and the role of the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA), useful for questions on consumer rights, regulatory frameworks, and the economic impact of environmental factors on the transport sector.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/india/stuck-at-airport-due-to-smog-heres-how-you-can-claim-a-refund-up-to-rs-10-000-from-indian-airlines-11765788489460.html>

US Goes Sherlock: Social-Media Background Checks on Every H-1B Tech Talent!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The U.S. State Department has started a comprehensive vetting process that includes reviewing the online presence of H-1B visa applicants, as well as students and exchange visitors on F, M, and J visas.

Detailed analysis:

For candidates focusing on International Relations and Economy, this development signals a tightening of immigration policy that could affect the Indian IT outsourcing industry, tech hiring trends, and bilateral trade. It underscores the importance of understanding visa categories, policy shifts, and their macro-economic repercussions—common themes in the Economy and International Relations papers.

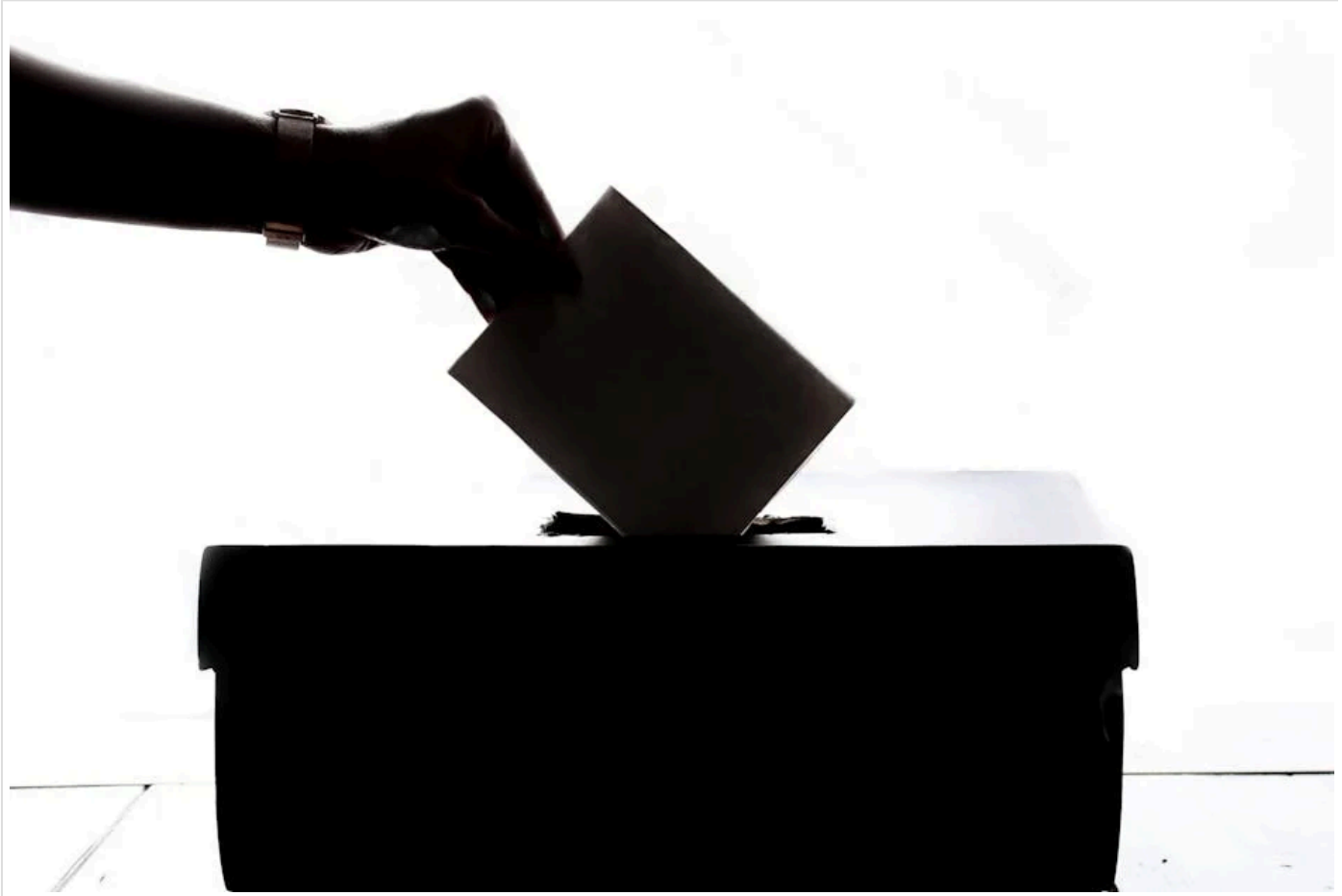
Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/us-news/trump-administration-begins-social-media-screening-of-h-1b-visa-holders-from-today-heres-what-to-expect-11765801826817.html>

Mumbai's Mega Municipal Polls Set for 2026 – All Eyes on the Model Code!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Elections for 29 municipal corporations, including the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC), will be held on 15 January 2026, with the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) taking effect immediately.

Detailed analysis:

Municipal elections influence urban infrastructure projects, public-private partnerships, and local taxation—areas directly linked to business administration and public finance. Aspirants should note the role of the MCC in curbing expenditure, a concept often examined in the Governance and Polity sections.

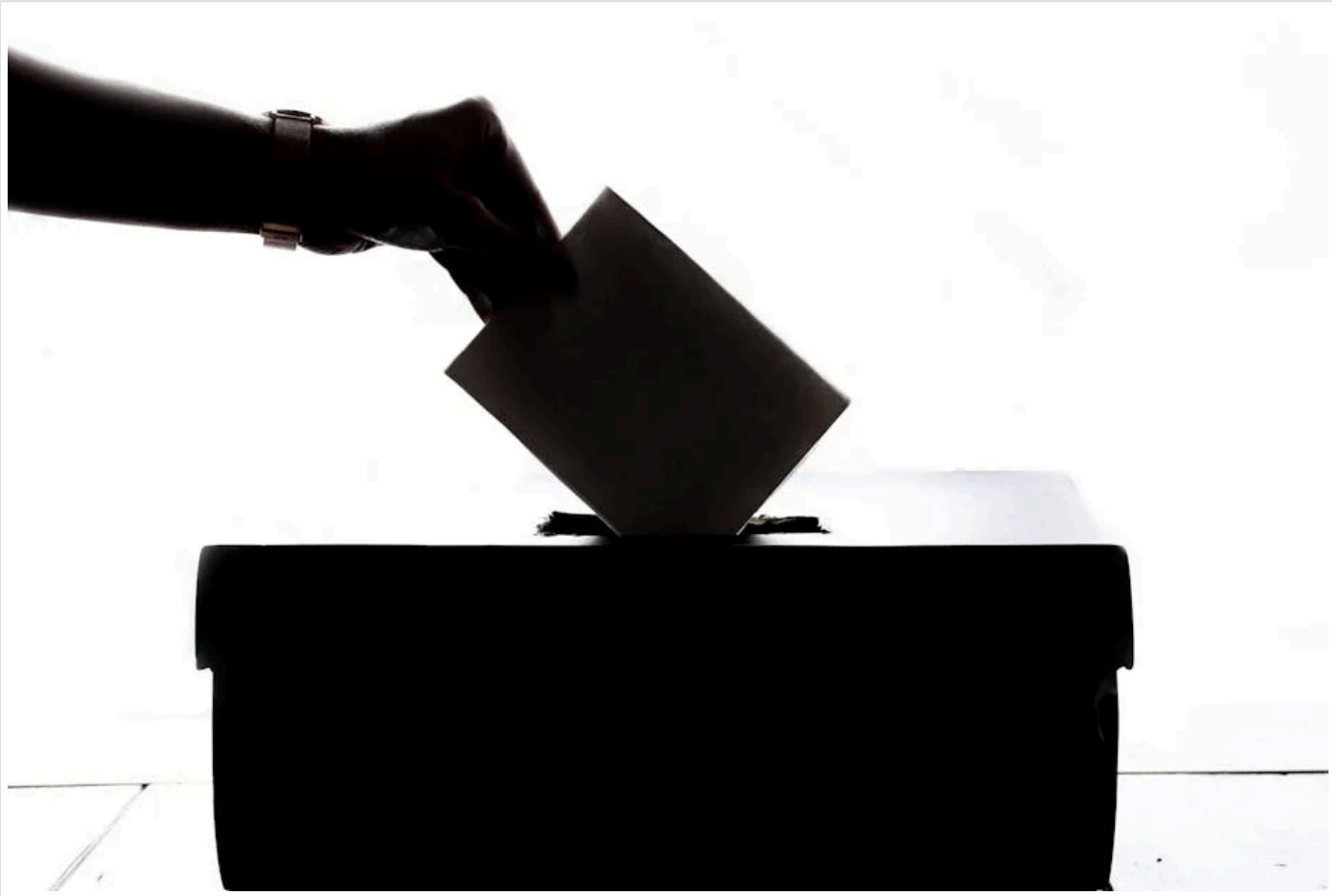
Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/india/bmc-elections-on-january-15-2026-counting-of-votes-on-january-16-mcc-comes-into-force-mumbai-civic-polls-11765796496320.html>

Power Play! Veteran MLA Sanjay Saraogi Takes the Helm of BJP Bihar – What It Means for Business

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Veteran legislator and former minister Sanjay Saraogi has been named the president of the Bharatiya Janata Party's Bihar unit, succeeding the previous leadership.

Detailed analysis:

Leadership changes in key states can reshape policy directions, affecting investment climate, industrial approvals, and labor regulations. For exam takers, this example highlights the interplay between state politics and economic development—a frequent topic in the Polity and Economy sections.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/india/fivetime-mla-ex-minister-sanjay-saraogi-appointed-bjps-new-bihar-unit-president-11765800476910.html>

Kolkata Builds a Giant Messi Monument in Days While the Metro Crawls – A Tale of Misplaced Priorities!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

A German YouTuber has sparked debate after a 70-foot Lionel Messi statue in Kolkata was erected within weeks, contrasting sharply with the prolonged delays in completing the city's metro projects.

Detailed analysis:

The story underscores issues of public spending, project management, and infrastructure bottlenecks—core themes in the Economy and Development sections. It prompts aspirants to evaluate how government priorities impact fiscal allocation, urban development, and investor confidence.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/trends/70ft-messi-statue-in-weeks-but-metro-took-decades-german-vlogger-questions-priorities-in-kolkata-11765797558993.html>

Messi's Bodyguard Rodrigo De Paul Heroically Fends Off Security to Save Young Fan!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Rodrigo De Paul is jokingly considered by fans to be Lionel Messi's bodyguard as the midfielder has always been by his side during Argentina duty.

Detailed analysis:

Shows the star power of Messi's India tour and the role of Argentine teammates in fan engagement—useful for questions on sports diplomacy and soft power in Indian exams.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/lionel-messis-delhi-visit-rodrico-de-paul-comes-to-young-fans-rescue-pushes-security-away-during-photo-shoot-watch-101765808513058.html>

Messi Gets Front-Row Ticket to India's T20 World Cup Opener from ICC Chief!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Lionel Messi's India tour concluded on Monday with the Argentine superstar being presented with the first ticket to the T20 World Cup by ICC chairman Jay Shah.

Detailed analysis:

Highlights cross-sport collaboration between football and cricket, a theme often asked in UPSC prelims on sports integration and national branding.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/lionel-messis-india-tour-concludes-with-a-bang-in-delhi-jay-shah-presents-him-with-first-ticket-to-t20-world-cup-101765800945693.html>

Olympic Champion Abhinav Bindra Slams India for Idolizing Messi Instead of Nurturing Homegrown Sports!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Abhinav Bindra raised a hard-hitting question on whether India is truly investing in a sporting culture or merely celebrating global stars from afar.

Detailed analysis:

Provides a critical perspective useful for essay questions on sports policy, infrastructure, and the balance between international events and grassroots development.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/abhinav-bindra-pained-by-lionel-messis-india-tour-are-we-building-sport-culture-or-just-celebrating-icons-from-afar-101765785760322.html>

Kolkata Chaos! Messi Event Slashed to 20 Minutes After Police Reveal Shocking Security Flaws!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The police commissioner said the Lionel Messi's Kolkata event was scheduled to last nearly two hours but was cut short to just 20 minutes after chaos erupted.

Detailed analysis:

Illustrates challenges of crowd management and security at high-profile events—relevant for administrative exam questions on law-and-order and event management.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/police-expose-lapses-in-kolkata-event-after-lionel-messi-tour-organisers-arrest-it-was-cut-from-1h-40m-to-20-minutes-101765780345837.html>

Messi Swaps Boots for Cricket Bat and Gets Team India Jersey – Day 3 of GOAT Tour!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Lionel Messi India Visit Day 3 Highlights: Messi, Luis Suarez and Rodrigo De Paul are currently in New Delhi for their final leg of the GOAT India Tour.

Detailed analysis:

Shows cultural integration between football and cricket, a point that can be cited in GK sections about India's sports diplomacy and fan outreach strategies.

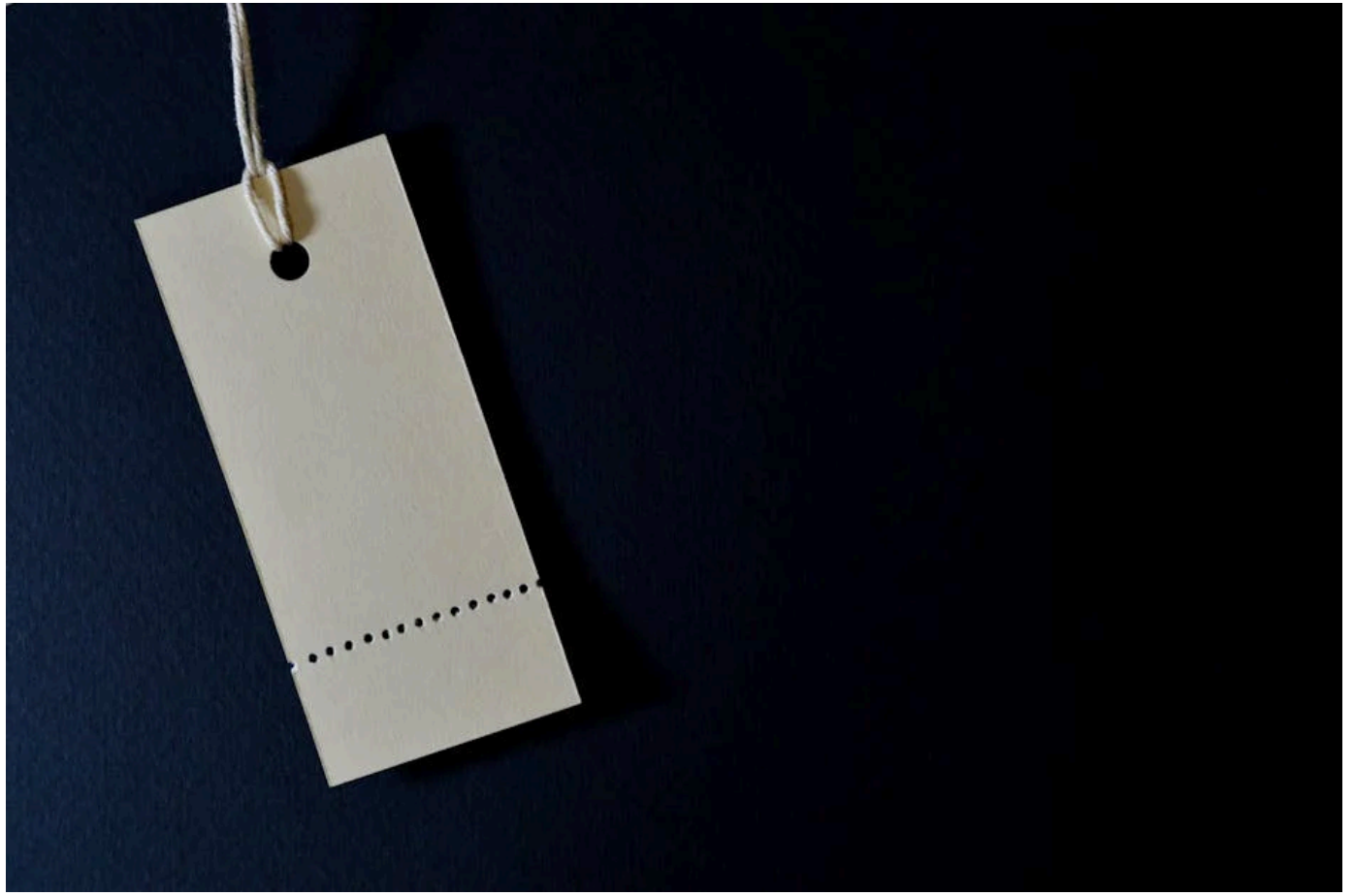
Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/lionel-messi-goat-tour-of-india-2025-day-3-live-updates-exhibition-match-at-arun-jaitley-stadium-delhi-latest-news-101765772946738.html>

Exclusive! Meet-and-Greet with Messi Prices Out Fans at a Whopping ₹1 Crore!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Following the lapses during the opening leg in Kolkata, where the City of Joy descended into chaos, security has been significantly tightened in New Delhi.

Detailed analysis:

Raises issues of commercialization of sports events and accessibility—useful for discussions on equity, pricing policies, and government regulation in sports management exams.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/want-to-meet-lionel-messi-in-delhi-closed-door-meet-and-greet-will-cost-inr-1-crore-101765770830011.html>

Lab-Made Eggs From Skin Cells: Scientists Claim Fertility Breakthrough!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The initial success of a pioneering experiment in the U.S. offers a glimpse into the future potential of lab-made gametes in fertility treatments, albeit alongside its scientific and ethical ramifications

Detailed analysis:

This breakthrough shows reprogramming somatic cells into gametes, a potential tool for infertility and genetic research, but raises ethical questions about embryo creation and regulatory oversight—key topics for biology and ethics sections of exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/inside-a-scientific-experiment-that-transformed-skin-cells-into-embryo-forming-eggs/article70371705.ece>

Quantum Wizards Win 2025 ICTP Prize – Their Secrets Could Power Future Computers!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The laureates' work is relevant to problems in keeping quantum devices, like quantum computers, under control and understanding what they do when they're not in equilibrium

Detailed analysis:

Their research tackles decoherence and non-equilibrium dynamics in quantum systems, crucial for advancing stable quantum computing—important for physics and technology portions of competitive exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/2025-ictp-prize-awarded-to-titas-chanda-sthitadhi-roy/article70397778.ece>

Scientists Turn Skin Cells Into Egg Precursors – A Leap Toward Lab-Made Babies!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The initial success of a pioneering experiment in the U.S. offers a glimpse into the future potential of lab-made gametes in fertility treatments, albeit alongside its scientific and ethical ramifications

Detailed analysis:

Highlights breakthrough reproductive technology; important for UPSC topics on biotechnology, bioethics, and future health policy.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/inside-a-scientific-experiment-that-transformed-skin-cells-into-embryo-forming-eggs/article70371705.ece>

1 Billion Children Victims – Lancet Reveals Massive Global Crisis!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The study provides new evidence linking sexual violence against children and intimate partner violence to a wider range of health outcomes than previously recognised, resulting in significantly higher levels of health loss and disability

Detailed analysis:

Underlines public health magnitude of child abuse; relevant for questions on health indicators, social determinants, and preventive strategies in civil services exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/over-1-billion-people-faced-childhood-sexual-violence-in-2023-lancet/article70398692.ece>

Tapering Antidepressants with Therapy Beats Cold-Turkey – New Study Says!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The study found that the most effective way for a patient to stop taking antidepressants was to gradually lower the dosage alongside seeing a psychologist

Detailed analysis:

Provides evidence-based guidance on deprescribing; useful for understanding mental health management and clinical protocols in health administration.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/new-study-suggests-best-way-to-stop-taking-antidepressants/article70398690.ece>

AIIMS Clears COVID Shots – No Connection to Sudden Young Adult Deaths!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Autopsy-based research shows coronary artery disease remains the leading cause; calls for targeted public health measures

Detailed analysis:

Strengthens vaccine safety narrative; important for public health policy, risk communication, and epidemiology sections of competitive exams.

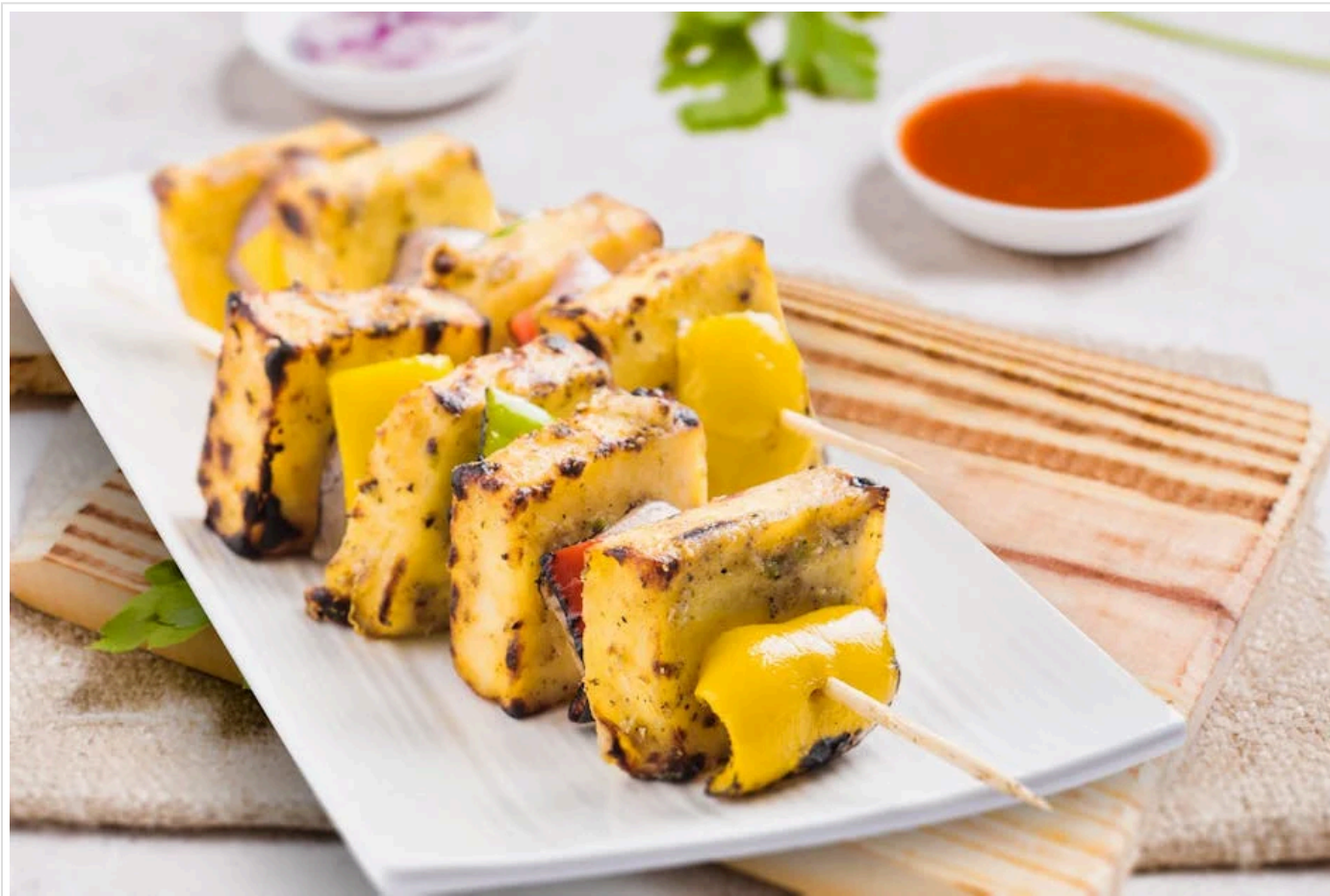
Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/aiims-study-finds-no-link-between-covid-vaccination-and-sudden-deaths-in-young-adults/article70395676.ece>

Winter Warmers: Guilt-Free Paneer Tikka Samosas to Boost Your Health!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Enjoy a flavour-packed Paneer Tikka Samosa Recipe made with marinated paneer, simple spices, and a lighter cooking method, a healthy snack for winter evenings.

Detailed analysis:

Illustrates practical nutrition tips; can be cited for diet-related questions in health and lifestyle sections of exams.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/health/paneer-tikka-samosa-recipe-a-flavourful-healthy-snack-for-winter-evenings-101765786325649.html>

Festive & Fit: 5 Low-Calorie Christmas Cookies You Can Bake Tonight!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Explore five easy and healthy Christmas cookie recipes made for beginners, using simple ingredients and lighter methods for guilt-free festive treats at home.

Detailed analysis:

Shows how traditional treats can be modified for better nutrition—a useful example for public health nutrition discussions.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/health/5-easy-and-healthy-christmas-cookies-recipes-to-try-at-home-for-beginners-101765784610276.html>

— EDUCATION —

Last Chance! GUJCET 2026 Registrations Open – Register Before Dec 30 or Miss Out!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Gujarat State Higher Secondary Education Board has opened registration for GUJCET 2026 from Dec 16 to Dec 30, 2025.

Detailed analysis:

Critical for engineering aspirants in Gujarat; early registration secures a slot and avoids last-minute hassles for the upcoming entrance exam.

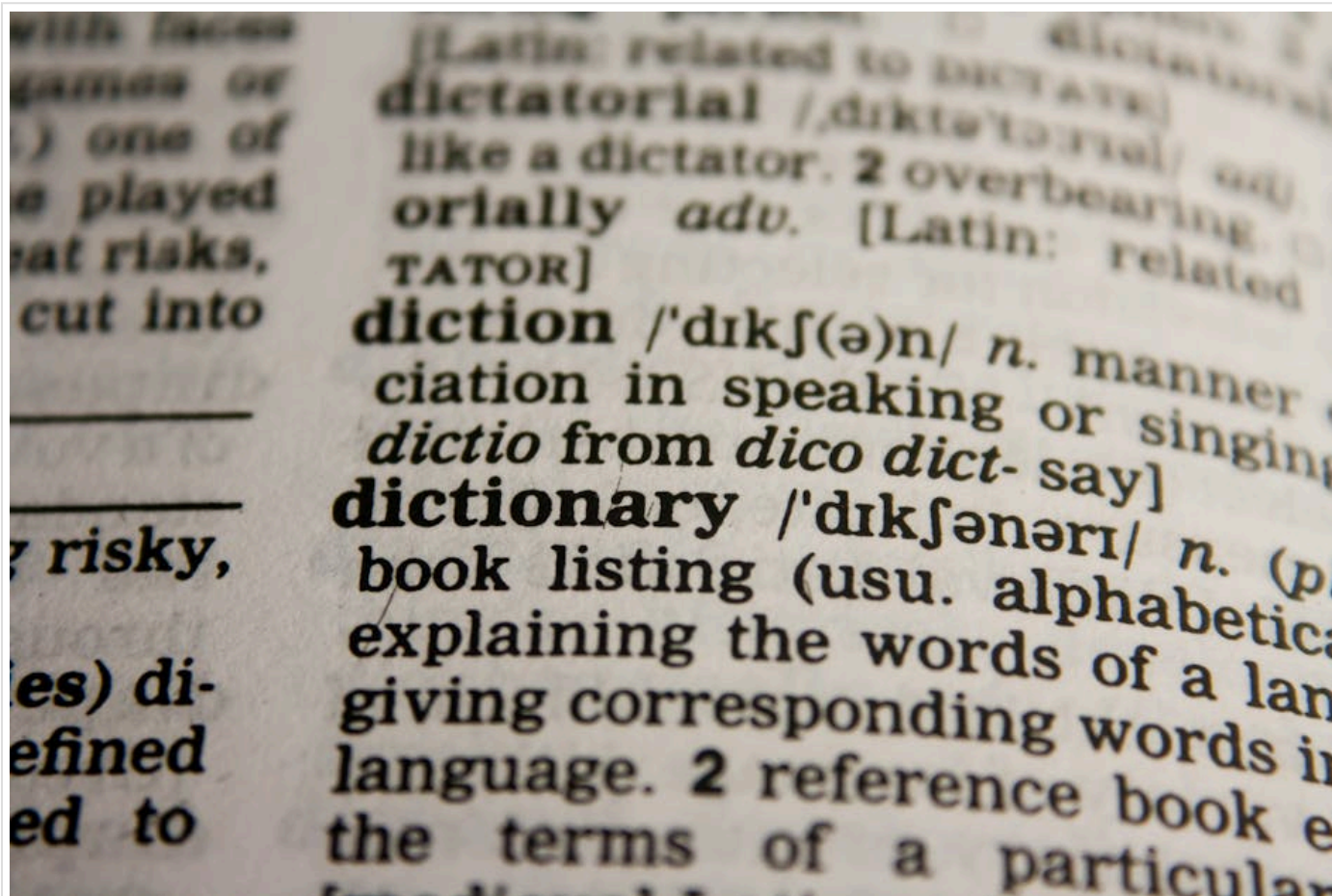
Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/competitive-exams/gujcet-2026-registration-opens-tomorrow-apply-till-december-30-101765799385790.html>

JEE Advanced 2026 Blueprint Unveiled – Master the New Physics, Maths & Chemistry Topics Now!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

IIT Roorkee publishes the full JEE Advanced 2026 syllabus, detailing all required topics across Physics, Mathematics, and Chemistry.

Detailed analysis:

Provides JEE aspirants with the exact roadmap for their preparation, enabling focused study and efficient time-management for the toughest engineering exam.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/jee-advanced-2026-syllabus-physics-mathematics-chemistry-iit-roorkee-10421064/>

CLAT 2026 Results Drop Tomorrow – Check Your Score and Rank Instantly!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The CLAT consortium will announce the 2026 law entrance exam results on December 17, providing scores and ranks for candidates.

Detailed analysis:

Law aspirants need this timeline to plan counselling, seat allocation and further preparation for their legal education journey.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/clat-2026-ug-result-pg-final-answer-keys-date-time-out-nlu-results-scorecard-ug-consortiumofnlus-ac-in-10420026/>

RRB NTPC Graduate CBT 2 Results Announced – 8,113 Vacancies Await!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The result for RRB NTPC Graduate CBT 2 2025 has been released, opening 8,113 railway posts for successful candidates.

Detailed analysis:

Essential for candidates targeting railway recruitment; the result triggers the next phase of document verification and posting.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/rrb-ntpc-graduate-cbt-2-result-2025-out-8113-vacancy-cbat-next-steps-sarkari-naukri-10421254/>

Ace the UPSC with Today's Lightning-Fast Current Affairs Quiz – Test Your Knowledge Now!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

A quick quiz covering the week's major stories with answers at the end, designed to sharpen UPSC aspirants' current-affairs knowledge.

Detailed analysis:

Regular quiz practice reinforces retention of vital news items, a must-have strategy for the UPSC prelims and mains exams.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/upsc-daily-current-affairs-quiz-indigo-dhurandhar-bondi-beach-festival-australia-shooting-pakistan-more-101765769846632.html>

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill 2025 proposes a single regulatory council, stripping funding powers from UGC, AICTE and NCTE and strengthening penalty provisions.

Detailed analysis:

A landmark policy shift that will affect accreditation, funding, and compliance for higher-education institutions across India, crucial for students, faculty and administrators to monitor.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/in-bill-set-to-replace-ugc-aicte-and-ncte-acts-regulatory-council-wont-have-powers-to-give-grants-to-institutions-10420583/>

SEBI's Bold Move to Slash Mutual Fund Fees and Demystify IPOs!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Sebi's board will discuss revamping mutual fund fee structures to enhance transparency and cost-efficiency for investors. Proposals include reducing total expense ratios and brokerage fees, alongside simplifying IPO disclosures and easing pre-IPO lock-in rules.

Detailed analysis:

Understanding the upcoming fee reforms helps aspirants answer questions on investor protection, cost efficiency and regulatory initiatives. The changes could lower expense ratios, making mutual funds more attractive for retail investors and aligning with the government's financial inclusion goals.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/markets/stocks/news/cost-efficiency-in-mind-mf-fees-under-review/articleshow/125968445.cms>

Foreign Investors Dump \$18.4 bn of Indian Stocks – Record Sell-off!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Foreign investors are selling Indian stocks at a record pace this year. They have offloaded \$18.4 billion in equities, surpassing the previous high. While primary market inflows have slowed, secondary market sales have reached an all-time peak. Domestic funds, however, continue to invest consistently in local equities.

Detailed analysis:

The surge in FPI outflows signals potential pressure on equity markets and can affect RBI's foreign exchange management. Exam takers should note the impact on market sentiment, capital account balance, and policy responses like tightening or easing of capital controls.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/markets/stocks/news/at-18-4-billion-fpi-equity-sales-hit-new-record/articleshow/125968517.cms>

JM Financial Eyes Private Markets to Outrun Capital Markets in 3 Years!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

JM Financial is focusing on wealth management and private markets for growth. Private markets are expected to become a major business, potentially exceeding capital markets in profitability within three years. The company is allocating significant capital to private markets.

Detailed analysis:

Highlights the shift from traditional capital markets to alternative assets, a trend likely to appear in questions on financial sector reforms, diversification, and the role of private equity in the Indian economy.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/markets/expert-view/private-markets-emerge-as-next-profit-engine-for-jm-financial-vishal-kampani/articleshow/125968422.cms>

Rupee Crashes Past 90 – Your Dream Vacation Now a Wallet Nightmare!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The rupee's slide past ₹90 to the dollar is making overseas travel costlier—not just to the US, but across Europe, the Maldives and parts of Asia, with uneven impact by destination.

Detailed analysis:

Currency depreciation affects import-price inflation, travel expenditure, and the balance of payments. Aspirants should connect this to RBI's monetary policy stance, foreign exchange reserves, and the impact on consumer spending.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/money/personal-finance/rupee-at-90-holiday-to-europe-maldives-and-parts-of-southeast-asia-cost-more-dollar-weakening-currency-rbi-11765778316221.html>

Top NPS Fund Managers Beat the Market – Who's Winning the Pension Race?

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

National Pension System subscribers can choose their fund managers – each of which has a unique portfolio of assets based on their investing philosophy.

Detailed analysis:

Knowledge of high-performing NPS fund managers is useful for questions on retirement planning, public pension schemes, and the effectiveness of market-linked pension options in India.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/money/personal-finance/nps-these-fund-managers-delivered-highest-return-on-equity-assets-in-past-3-years-see-list-11765805987021.html>

SEBI Hunts Down 'Baap of Charts' – ₹17 Cr Recovery Mission!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Sebi launched a crackdown on Ansari and his firm in 2023 when he was banned from trading in the securities market

Detailed analysis:

Demonstrates regulatory vigilance against unregistered advisory activities. Important for exams covering securities law, investor protection, and the role of SEBI in curbing misinformation.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/money/personal-finance/sebi-starts-proceedings-against-this-finfluencer-to-recover-over-rs-17-crore-11765803907471.html>

— ENVIRONMENT —

Delhi's Smog Crisis Forces Kids to Ditch Classrooms!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Delhi's AQI stood in the 'severe' category on December 15 with a reading of 427, after touching the second highest AQI on record for December on December 14 at 461.

Detailed analysis:

The article highlights the acute air-quality emergency in the capital, prompting the government to move younger students to online learning. It underscores the health impacts of high PM2.5 levels, the need for emergency policy responses, and the link between urban pollution and educational disruption—key topics for UPSC and state PSC environment sections.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/pollution-woes-delhi-government-directs-schools-to-shift-from-hybrid-to-online-mode-up-to-class-5/article70399574.ece>

Village-Scale Data Revolution Takes on Climate Change!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

A new community-driven MRV framework is bringing real-time, village-scale environmental data into Tamil Nadu's climate governance system

Detailed analysis:

This piece showcases a grassroots Monitoring, Reporting, Verification (MRV) model that feeds localized climate data into state policy. It exemplifies participatory governance, the role of citizen science in climate mitigation, and the integration of real-time data for adaptive management—important concepts for environmental governance questions in competitive exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/op-ed/a-people-led-climate-intelligence-movement/article70395961.ece>
